SECURITY PROVENANCE SOLUTIONS LLC

Arms Provenance

User Manual

A private, offline record book for your firearms, suppressors, bows, ammunition and gear. This guide walks you through installing the app, entering your collection, making a backup, and unlocking the plan you purchased.

Version 1.13.0

Know what you own, and where it came from.

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1. Welcome

Arms Provenance is a private collection log for firearms, suppressors, archery equipment, ammunition and accessories. It is made by Security Provenance Solutions LLC for collectors who want one place to keep those records organized, accessible and private.

You can record what you own, where it came from, where it is stored, and where it goes next. You can attach photos and paperwork, keep a cleaning schedule, and — on Full — print Item Sheets, a Bill of Sale, collection reports and estate paperwork.

This manual describes Arms Provenance version 1.13.0 on Android and Windows. A few features differ by plan (Lite, Ammo or Full) or by device. Those differences are called out as they come up.

> Arms Provenance is a personal record-keeping tool, not a compliance tool. You are responsible for following federal, state and local law. Please never email real serial numbers to support.

2. Privacy and how your records are kept

Your collection lives only on your own devices, in an encrypted database, behind a PIN. There are no Arms Provenance accounts, no ads and no analytics.

- **Google Play (Android) builds** do not have internet permission. Purchases are handled by the Google Play app, not by Arms Provenance itself. Links such as Laws & Resources open in your phone's web browser.
- **Website Android builds and the Windows app** also keep your records on the device and do not connect to the internet. Purchases from the website are unlocked with a license key you enter in the app (see Section 12). Links still open in your browser.

The app locks again if it has been in the background for about one minute. On Android you can also unlock with fingerprint or face, and on Windows with Windows Hello, with your PIN as the backup.

> **If you forget your PIN, it cannot be recovered.** Make encrypted backups and keep the backup password somewhere safe. A backup uses its own password — not your PIN — and does not include the PIN itself.

3. Installing the app

Android, from the website

After you buy from the Arms Provenance or Security Provenance website, you will receive a download of the Android app (an APK file).

1. Download the file to your phone.
2. Open the downloaded file from your notifications or your Files app.
3. If Android asks you to allow installs from the browser or Files, allow it for this install, then return to the file and open it again.
4. Tap **Install**, and when it finishes, tap **Open**.

This website copy is the same Arms Provenance app you would get from Google Play, with one difference: unlocks are entered with a license key instead of a Play Store purchase.

Android, from Google Play

Open the Arms Provenance listing in the Google Play Store and tap Install. Updates arrive through the Play Store. Unlocks are bought in the app through Google Play (see Section 13).

Windows

After a website purchase that includes Windows, download the Windows app to your PC (Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit).

1. If you received a setup program, run it and follow the prompts.
2. If you received a ZIP file or a folder, unzip it if needed, then open **ArmsProvenance.exe**. Keep every file that came with the program in the same folder — the app needs those files beside it.

Windows uses a mouse, keyboard and a side menu on a wide window. It cannot scan an ammo box with a camera, and it cannot take a photo with a webcam. Choose a picture or PDF file instead.

4. First launch

The first time you open Arms Provenance you will see **Create a PIN to protect your collection**.

1. Choose a PIN of 4 to 8 digits and tap **Continue**.
2. Enter the same PIN again and tap **Set PIN**.

If your device offers fingerprint, face unlock or Windows Hello, the app turns that option on after you set the PIN. You can change this later under Settings. Your PIN remains the backup.

Each later time you open the app, unlock with your PIN or with biometrics.

> The screen reminds you: your data is stored only on this device, encrypted. If you forget this PIN there is no way to recover it. A backup (Section 10) is the way to reopen your collection on a new device.

5. Finding your way around

Along the bottom of the phone — or in the side menu on a wide Windows window — there are three areas:

- **Collection** — your home screen, with a tile for each part of the collection.
- **Notifications** — cleaning that is due, due soon or never recorded, and low-stock ammunition.
- **Admin** — reports, documents, the archive, backups, CSV import and export, and menu editing.

The gear icon in the top-right opens **Settings**. On Collection, the `Add` button starts a new item of any type.

On Windows, you can also use:

- **Ctrl+1**, **Ctrl+2**, **Ctrl+3** — Collection, Notifications, Admin
- **Ctrl+,** — Settings
- **Ctrl+N** — Add

The Collection home screen

By default the home screen has five tiles: **Firearms**, **Suppressors**, **Archery**, **Ammunition** and **Accessories**. Tap a tile to open that list.

Tap `Edit home` to rearrange tiles, add a picture to a tile, or choose `Remove from home`. Removing a tile never deletes any items — they are still in the collection. You can add the tile back later.

6. Adding and editing items

You can add an item from the home screen `Add` button, or from inside a list. Fill in the form and save. Required fields are marked; for firearms, bows, suppressors and most other items, **Make** and **Model** are required. Everything else can be added now or later.

Open any item to see its page. From there you can edit it, add photos, attach documents, mark it cleaned, or archive it.

> Limits only stop you from adding new items. Anything you have already entered stays visible, editable and exportable, even if you are over a plan's limit or after a change in plan.

Firearms

On the firearm form, **Type** is a list that includes Pistol, Revolver, Rifle, **AR-Style**, Shotgun, Short-barreled rifle (SBR), Short-barreled shotgun (SBS), Machine gun, Muzzleloader and Other. Choose **AR-Style** when that is the right description for the firearm. It is a type, not a separate section of the app.

You can also record a serial number (and extra serials), caliber, year, antique or C&R notes, NFA and trust details, round count, last used, last cleaned, condition, value, storage location, heir information and how the item was acquired or left the collection.

Lite and Ammo can keep up to 5 active firearms. Full has no firearm limit.

Suppressors

Suppressors have their own list, with make, model, type, caliber, serials, NFA and trust details, cleaning dates and the same acquisition, condition, value, storage and heir sections.

Adding a new suppressor requires Full. Suppressors you already entered stay viewable and editable on every plan.

Archery

The Archery tile is for bows and crossbows (Compound, Recurve, Longbow, Crossbow, or Other). You can record draw weight, handedness, serial and the usual acquisition and storage details.

Adding a new bow requires Full. Bows already entered stay viewable and editable on every plan.

Ammunition

Ammunition is kept in lots. A lot can be cartridges (the usual default), or arrows, crossbow bolts, broadheads or field points. Record caliber or load, brand, quantity on hand and, if you want, a low-stock alert. When quantity falls to that number or below, the lot appears in Notifications.

Lite can keep up to 10 active ammo and arrow lots. Ammo and Full allow unlimited lots.

On **Android**, the ammunition list has a `Scan box` button. Point the camera at the box (or take a photo of the label) and the app reads the barcode and printed text to help fill in a new lot. You can always enter a lot by hand. **Windows does not scan boxes** — enter the lot yourself.

Accessories and optics

Optics are entered as accessories. When you add an accessory, set **Type** to Optic — or to Magazine, Holster, Light, Laser, Sling, Case / Safe, Mount / Rings, Stock / Grip, Bipod, Cleaning, Ear / Eye protection, or Other.

You can link an accessory to a firearm, suppressor or bow, and note whether it is stored with that item or separately. Quantity on hand is kept on the accessory; each accessory entry counts once toward the plan limit, whatever the quantity.

Lite and Ammo can keep up to 10 active accessory entries. Full has no accessory limit.

Trusts, NFA details, and C&R

Gun trusts are managed in Settings → **Trusts** (exact name, date, trustees and the trust document). On a firearm or suppressor you can set Registered to Individual or Trust, plus ATF Control # and an optional paper tax stamp serial.

If you hold a C&R (FFL 03) license, turn on **I hold a C&R (FFL 03) license** in Settings. That adds the transferee's date of birth and ID type / number to dispositions and to the A&D Ledger.

Archiving an item

When an item is sold, traded, gifted, stolen, lost, destroyed or transferred to an heir, open it and choose `Archive (sold, traded, stolen...)`. You will be asked for a reason. Archived items leave your everyday lists and move to Admin → **Archive**, where you can restore them. They are not deleted.

7. Photos and documents

Every item type can have photos. On the item page, tap `Add photo`:

- **Android:** `Take photo` or choose from your gallery.
- **Windows:** choose a picture file. The app does not use a webcam.

New pictures have GPS and other camera details removed before they are saved. A picture that cannot be cleaned is refused, so location data is not stored in your collection.

On the same item page, **Documents** is for receipts, bills of sale, tax stamps, police reports and similar files. You can add a camera photo (Android), a gallery or picture file, and a label so you can find it later.

Photos and documents are included in an encrypted backup.

8. Dirty badges and cleaning

Firearms and suppressors can track cleaning. Each one has **Last cleaned** and **Clean every (days)**. If you leave the interval blank, the app uses the default from Settings, which starts at 30 days.

A small **Dirty** badge appears on a firearm or suppressor when cleaning is due today or overdue. A firearm also shows Dirty if it has a last-used date and has not been cleaned on that day or later. A firearm that has never been used is not marked Dirty for that reason. "Due soon" (within three days), with no use since the last cleaning, does not show the badge.

Ways to record a cleaning:

- On the item page, tap `Cleaned today` or `Mark cleaned today`.
- From a list, select items and choose `Mark cleaned today`.
- On the Notifications tab, tap `Mark cleaned`.

You can undo a cleaning you just recorded. Notifications also lists items due soon and items with no cleaning date yet. Optional reminders can be turned on in Settings (see Section 15). Reminder notifications do not show item names on the lock screen.

9. Search and filters

Open any list and use the search box at the top — for example, *Search firearms*. The search looks through the fields on each item, including a trust name when one is set.

You can also:

- Filter by **storage location**.
- On firearms and suppressors, filter by **trust** (a specific trust, any trust, or individually owned).
- Use the category tabs on a list (for example All, or a type) when they appear.

10. Backup and restore, including phone to PC

Open Admin → **Backup & Restore**. A backup is a single password-protected file ending in **.ctbackup**. It contains all of your items, photos, documents and cleaning history. It does *not* include your PIN, biometrics setting, reminder settings or saved seller details.

Create a backup

1. Tap **Create backup**.
2. Set a backup password of at least 8 characters, then confirm it. Write this password down somewhere safe. It cannot be recovered, and without it the backup cannot be opened.
3. When the file is ready, choose **Save to a folder...** or **Share / send to...** (for example Drive, email to yourself, or a USB folder).

Keep the file somewhere other than the device you just backed up. You can also set a backup reminder (7, 14, 30, 60, 90 or 180 days, or Off) and, on a phone, an optional notification when a backup is due.

Open a backup

1. On the destination device, open Admin → Backup & Restore → **Open a backup**.
2. Choose the .ctbackup file and enter the backup password.
3. On the **Use this backup** screen, review what would be added, and any items that exist on both sides.
4. Choose **Save merge** to combine records, or **Replace entire collection** to make this device match the backup. Replace asks for confirmation, because it removes what is only on this device. A safety copy is kept so you can choose **Recover safety copy** if you need to undo a replace.

If the same item changed on both sides, you can keep this device's version, use the backup's version, or apply one of those choices to all conflicts.

Moving from phone to PC (or back)

1. On the phone, create a backup and copy the .ctbackup file to the PC (USB drive, email to yourself, or a folder both devices can reach).
2. Install Arms Provenance on the PC, create a PIN for that computer, then open the backup as described above.
3. To go the other way, create the backup on the PC and open it on the phone.

> A backup is how you move a collection between devices today. The app does not sync over a USB cable or Wi-Fi. Each device has its own PIN. After you restore, enter your website license key again on a website or Windows copy if that device should be unlocked (see Section 12). A Google Play purchase can be restored on a phone with **Restore purchases**.

11. Plans: Lite, Ammo, Full, and Collector's Edition

There are three unlock levels in the app: **Lite** (free), **Ammo** and **Full**. Collector's Edition is Full on both Android and Windows, shown in the app as "Collector's Edition" when a license covers both platforms.

WHAT YOU CAN DO	LITE	AMMO	FULL / COLLECTOR'S
Active firearms	Up to 5	Up to 5	Unlimited
Active accessories	Up to 10	Up to 10	Unlimited
Ammo and arrow lots	Up to 10	Unlimited	Unlimited
Add suppressors or bows	No	No	**Yes**
Photos, CSV, encrypted backups	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Ammo Log (current inventory)	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Ammo Log with use and restock history	No	**Yes**	**Yes**
Collection Report and Archive Report	No	No	**Yes**
Item Sheet, Bill of Sale, A&D Ledger	No	No	**Yes**
Estate planning and Estate Report	No	No	**Yes**
Windows and Android together	Separate purchases or keys, per device		Collector's Edition is Full on both

Planned one-time prices, subject to change: Ammo $9.99, Full $19.99, Collector's Edition (phone and PC together) $29.99. There is no subscription. A locked tool in Admin shows the plan it needs and opens Upgrade when you tap it.

12. Entering a license key

License keys are available with website purchases. They unlock Ammo or Full on the website Android build and on Windows. A Collector's Edition key unlocks Full on both platforms.

Google Play copies do not use a license key. Those unlocks stay in Google Play (see Section 13).

1. On the website or Windows copy, open Settings (the gear icon), or open Settings → **Upgrade**.
2. In the **License key** box, paste the key from your purchase email. Keys begin with **AP1.** Spaces and line breaks around the key are fine; the app ignores them.
3. Tap **Activate license**.

When the key is accepted, you will see a thank-you message and the edition that was unlocked, the platforms it covers, and the name it is registered to. That status also appears in Settings.

If you are entering an **upgrade key** and the app asks for more, a second box appears: **Existing license key or order number**. Paste your earlier key or the order number from your purchase, then activate again.

Common messages, and what they mean:

- *This doesn't look like an Arms Provenance license key* — the text is incomplete or not a key. Paste the whole key, starting with AP1.
- *This key is not valid* or *This key is no longer valid* — the key does not match, or it has been revoked. Contact support.
- *This key is for Windows, and this is an Android copy* (or the other way around) — use the key on the platform it was issued for, or a Collector's Edition key that covers both.
- *This is an upgrade key. Enter your existing license key or your order number too.* — fill in the second box as described above.
- *A higher-tier license is already on this copy* — this device already has Full. You do not need a lower key.

> A license key stays on that copy of the app. After you reinstall, or after you restore a backup onto a new device, paste the key again. The backup file does not contain the key, and it does not contain your PIN.

13. Upgrading

Website and Windows copies

Buy the plan or upgrade you need on the website, then enter the license key as in Section 12. Your records are not changed when a plan is unlocked.

Google Play copies

Open Settings → **Upgrade**. The screen shows **You have:** your current plan, then Lite, Ammo and Full.

- From Lite, you can **Buy Ammo** or **Buy Full**.
- From Ammo, you can **Upgrade to Full**.
- If you reinstall the app, get a new phone, or redeem a Play promo code, tap **Restore purchases**. Redeem promo codes in the Play Store app (Profile → Payments & subscriptions → Redeem code), then restore.

Paid once, yours for good — no subscription. Unlocking never hides or removes anything you have entered.

14. Reports, archive, and other Admin tools

The Admin tab is grouped into Reports & documents, Records and Data.

Reports & documents

- **Collection Report** (Full) — a printable PDF of firearms, suppressors, bows, optics, lights, lasers and linked accessories.
- **Archive Report** (Full) — a printable PDF of items you sold, traded, gifted or lost, with who they went to and the price.
- **Ammo Log** — a printable PDF of ammo and arrow lots on hand. Use and restock history is part of Ammo and Full; Lite can still print the current inventory.
- **Item Sheet** (Full) — a PDF of one item, or several, each on its own pages, with photos, serial, linked accessories and receipts, for police or insurance. You can mask serial numbers when you need to share a copy more carefully.
- **Bill of Sale** (Full) — fill in and print a bill of sale for one item, or several sold together. You can record the sale back onto the items.

Records

- **Archive** — items you have archived; you can restore them to your lists.
- **A&D Ledger** (Full) — an acquisition and disposition record of every firearm and suppressor, oldest first, as PDF or CSV. Bows are not listed, because they are not firearms. The ledger itself reminds you that Arms Provenance is not a compliance tool.
- **Estate** (Full) — executor, where keys, safe codes and paperwork are kept, heir details on items, and the Estate Report packet. You can also open Estate from Settings.

Data

- **CSV Import & Export** — move items to or from spreadsheet files, one file per item type. Available on every plan. You can export with serial numbers masked.
- **Backup & Restore** — see Section 10.
- **Edit Item Drop Down Menus** — remove a menu choice you do not use. Values already saved on items are kept.

15. Settings

Open Settings from the gear icon. You will find:

- **Appearance** — Dark, Light or System.
- **Show dismissed notices again** — brings back notes you hid with “Got it”.
- **Cleaning reminders** — “Remind me when cleaning is due,” plus the default cleaning interval. A notification is sent at about 9 AM on the due day, and weekly while overdue. Names are not

shown on the lock screen. On a phone, Android must be allowed to notify the app; on a PC, notifications must be allowed for this computer.

- **Unlocks** — Upgrade, and either the license key box (website and Windows) or Restore purchases (Google Play).
- **Records** — C&R license, Trusts, and Estate.
- **Laws & Resources** — set your home state, then open official ATF and state links in your browser. The app never uses GPS or location tracking; home state is only so the right links can be shown.
- **Security** — Unlock with biometrics, and Change PIN.
- **Copy diagnostic log** — copies a log file from the app's data folder if you are asked for it while troubleshooting. It is for diagnosing a problem, not a copy of your collection.
- **Privacy** and the About line, which shows the app version.

16. Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO TRY
You forgot your PIN	The PIN cannot be recovered. If you have a .ctbackup file and its password, you can install the app again, set a new PIN, and open the backup. Without a backup, the collection on that device cannot be opened.
You forgot the backup password	That password cannot be recovered, and the backup cannot be opened. Create a new backup from a device that still opens, and store the new password safely.
Android will not install the website APK	Use the Files app or the browser's download list, allow that app to install this package when Android asks, then open the file again.
A license key is not accepted	Paste the entire key, starting with AP1. Use it on the platform it was issued for. For an upgrade key, also enter your earlier key or order number. If it still fails, email support@securityprovenance.com — without serial numbers.
A Google Play purchase is missing after reinstall	Open Settings → Upgrade → **Restore purchases**, and confirm you are signed into the same Google account that bought the plan.
You cannot add another firearm, accessory, or ammo lot	You have reached the limit for your plan. Existing items stay safe. Open Settings → Upgrade if you want a higher plan.
You cannot add a suppressor or bow	Those are part of Full. Anything already entered stays visible and editable.
Scan box is missing or does not work	Box scanning is on Android only, from the Ammunition list. If the camera is off, allow Camera for Arms Provenance in Android Settings. On Windows, enter the lot by hand.
Cleaning reminders do not appear	Turn on "Remind me when cleaning is due" in Settings, and allow notifications for Arms Provenance in the phone or computer's settings.
A photo is refused	The app removes GPS and other camera details before saving. If a picture cannot be cleaned, it is not stored. Try a different photo, or a copy exported without location data.
Windows will not start, or files seem missing	Open ArmsProvenance.exe from the folder that also contains the other files from the download. Do not move the .exe out by itself.

17. Support and legal

A real person reads every message. For app help and feedback:

support@securityprovenance.com

Please do not email real serial numbers. If you are sending a diagnostic log, you can copy it from Settings → Copy diagnostic log.

For business or general questions: info@securityprovenance.com

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The website, Privacy Policy, Terms of Use and EULA are at **armsprovenance.com** and **securityprovenance.com**.

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